

structural material. The Rand Corporation, among other things correctly foretold, shortly after the war, the development in titanium.

“More immediate than any eventual market that may develop for beryllium as a structural material, 1958 should see this company bring into volume production another brand-new product. This is beryllium metal for atomic purposes. This product, being made in a completely separate plant from the older master-alloy lines, is under long-term contract to the Atomic Energy Commission. It gives indications of having a big future in the nuclear industry where demand will probably occur from both government and private industry sources. Management is alert. In fact, this company qualifies rather favorably under our fifteen points in regard to all aspects but one, where the deficiency is realized and steps have already been started to correct it.”

As in the case of Mallory, the past two years have brought both pluses and minuses to the picture I portrayed at that time. However, the favorable developments seem to have by far outweighed the unfavorable, as should be the case if a company is to prove the right sort of investment. On the unfavorable side, the prospects for beryllium copper dies, mentioned two years before, appear to have lost much of their luster and the long-term growth curve of the entire alloy end of the business may be somewhat less brisk than indicated in that description. Meanwhile, nuclear demand for beryllium metal over the next few years appears to be somewhat less now than it was then. However, possibly far outbalancing this, there are steadily increasing signs that there may be a most dramatic growth in the demand for beryllium metal for many types of airborne purposes. The start of this demand is already here. It is appearing in so many places and for so many different kinds of products that no one is safe in predicting what its limitations may be. This may not prove quite as favorable as might otherwise be judged, for it may make the field so attractive as to bring threats of a major competitive technological breakthrough from some company not now in the field. However, fortunately, the company may have made major strides in strengthening itself in the only one of our fifteen points where it had been weak. This was in its research activities.